

What is Kokoro Link?

Kokoro Link is a personalized digital life-navigation platform designed to support foreign professionals and their families as they relocate and integrate into life in Japan. Rather than offering fragmented information, the platform provides a structured, life-stage–based system that helps users understand, plan, and manage administrative and daily life processes.

Upon signing up, users input key information such as visa type, family status, language ability, and long-term plans. Kokoro Link then generates a customized dashboard with step-by-step guidance, timelines, and explanations covering areas like healthcare, housing, banking, education, and legal procedures.

The platform goes beyond translation by helping users understand how systems work, reducing uncertainty and dependence. It also offers practical support such as document guidance, booking assistance, and optional access to consultants when needed.

By combining personalization, clarity, and accessibility, Kokoro Link empowers users to become more independent while reducing the burden on HR teams. It creates a smoother, more confident integration experience, especially during the critical first few months in Japan.

5 highlighted features

1. Personalized Checklist

Generates a step-by-step action plan based on the user’s situation, reducing confusion about what to do and when.

2. System Explanation Layer

Explains how Japanese systems work (not just instructions), helping users build understanding and confidence.

3. Translation & Interpretation Support

Translates documents and supports communication, reducing anxiety caused by language barriers.

4. Assisted Booking Services

Allows users to book appointments without a Japanese phone number, solving real-life access issues.

5. Life-Stage Adaptive Dashboard

Updates recommendations over time (e.g., schooling, license conversion), ensuring relevance as needs change.

User Journey

I am a 32-year-old software engineer from Canada, and I recently accepted a job offer in Nagano. My wife and I saw this as a long-term opportunity, and we decided to relocate with our five-year-old child. At first, the move felt exciting—a new country, a new career step, and a fresh start for our family. However, that excitement quickly turned into stress once the administrative process began. While my company's HR supported me with my visa and Certificate of Eligibility, I soon realized that many other essential procedures were my responsibility.

Before arriving in Japan, I was told I needed to complete several tasks, including:

- Registering at the town hall
- Enrolling in health insurance and pension
- Opening a bank account
- Securing housing
- Enrolling my child in school

Although the list seemed straightforward, the reality was much more complicated. Most official information was in Japanese, and even when English resources were available, they were often incomplete or inconsistent. I struggled to understand which steps were urgent, what documents were required, and whether I needed appointments in advance. More than the language barrier, what overwhelmed me was the lack of clarity and structure. I constantly worried about making mistakes or missing important deadlines that could affect my family's stability in Japan.

During my search for guidance, I came across a personalized support platform designed for foreign residents in Japan. After creating an account, I was asked to input details about my situation, such as my visa type, family status, my child's age, and our long-term plans. Based on this information, the platform generated a customized checklist and timeline tailored specifically to me.

Instead of a generic list, I received a structured plan organized into clear stages:

- Before arrival
- First week in Japan
- First month
- First three months

Each task came with detailed explanations, including why it was necessary, when it should be completed, what documents were required, and what to expect during the process. For the first time, I felt like I understood not just *what* to do, but *why* I was doing it.

When I arrived in Japan, I relied heavily on the platform's dashboard. Rather than repeatedly contacting HR or searching online, I followed the step-by-step guidance provided. At the town hall, I already knew what documents to bring and how the process would work. When enrolling in health insurance and pension, I understood how the system functioned and what my responsibilities were. This significantly reduced my stress and uncertainty.

One of the most helpful features was the ability to upload official documents. Whenever I received government letters in Japanese, I no longer felt anxious. Instead, I uploaded them to the platform and

received clear explanations of their content and any required actions. This transformed what used to be a stressful experience into a manageable one.

As I continued using the platform, I also explored its consultant services. Through this, I received personalized support in finding appropriate schooling options for my child in Nagano. The consultant guided me through enrollment procedures, required documents, and available choices, which would have been extremely difficult to navigate on my own.

Over time, I noticed a shift in how I interacted with my company's HR. I still reached out when necessary, but my questions became more specific and informed. Instead of asking general questions, I could clarify particular details. This not only saved time for me but also reduced the administrative burden on HR, who sometimes lacked detailed knowledge of systems affecting foreign employees.

Six months later, as I began considering longer-term goals such as converting my driver's license and applying for permanent residency, the platform adapted to my needs. It updated my dashboard with new guidance relevant to my life stage and future plans. Additionally, I was introduced to a Japanese language learning course through the platform's partnership and connected with Japanese learners who wanted to practice English. This created an opportunity for mutual exchange, helping me gradually integrate into the local community.

Looking back, the biggest change was not just that I completed the necessary procedures—it was that I gained confidence and understanding. I moved from feeling overwhelmed and dependent to becoming capable and independent. I now understand how key systems in Japan work, and I feel more in control of my life here. At the same time, my employer benefits from reduced administrative strain, as I no longer rely on them for every question.

Overall, the platform transformed what initially felt like a confusing and stressful transition into a structured, manageable, and empowering experience for both me and my family.